

KARU

Rent a car in Cameroon. Verified, every time.

The first verified, two-sided car rental marketplace for Douala & Yaoundé.

THE PROBLEM

Renting a car here is a gamble.

Today, getting a car in Cameroon means a phone number from a group chat — and a lot of hope. No checks on the car, the owner, or the price. Scams are a recognised, named problem, rooted in the absence of any fast, reliable way to verify who you're dealing with before you pay.

The gap isn't cars. It's trust.

No verification

Of the car, the owner, or the renter — both sides fly blind.

Opaque pricing

Negotiated, cash, no record — and no one to call when it goes wrong.

Fragmented supply

Dozens of agencies and informal listings, none aggregated or trusted.

Four substitutes — none of them trusted.

1

Intl franchises

Avis · Europcar · Hertz

Airport & expat-focused. \$62–238/day, FX-priced, no MoMo. Not built for locals.

2

Local agencies

Global Bush · Alicya · Habari

Credible but fragmented. Phone/WhatsApp booking, opaque negotiated prices.

3

Informal market

Facebook · WhatsApp · classifieds

Largest by volume, lowest trust. No checks, no recourse, scam-prone.

4

Ride-hailing

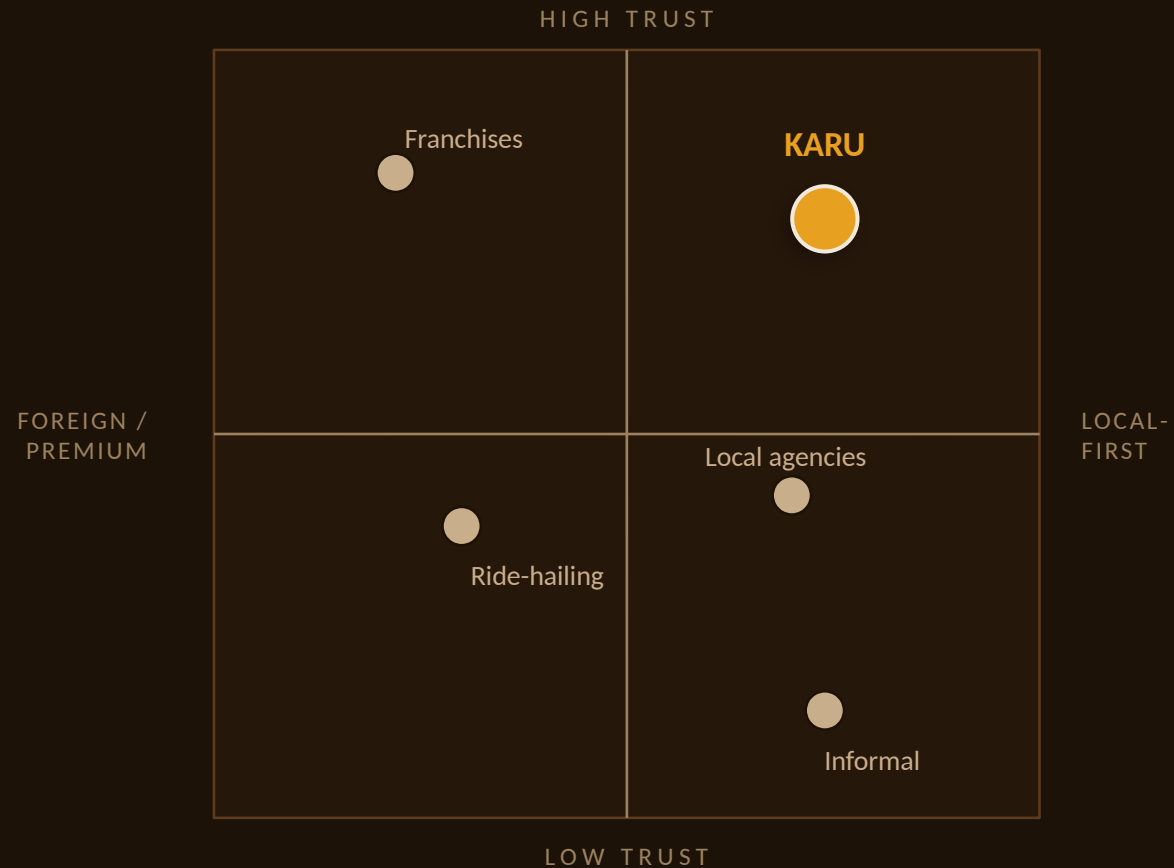
Yango · OnGo · Gozem

Adjacent & dangerous: real apps and payment, but built for rides, not rental.

The verified, two-sided marketplace model is proven in Lagos, Nairobi and Johannesburg — and has never reached Cameroon.

THE GAP

The top-right quadrant is empty.



Karu's wedge

High trust AND local-first is unoccupied. Karu brings franchise-grade verification to the everyday, locally-priced rental the franchises ignore and the informal market can't make safe.

THE SOLUTION

Karu makes every rental verified.

A two-sided marketplace where every car, owner and renter is checked before a booking — with transparent FCFA pricing, MoMo payment, and a record behind every trip. We aggregate fragmented supply and put a trust layer on top.



Verified vehicles

Every car checked before it is listed — honest photos, real condition.



Verified people

Owners and renters confirmed, both ways. You know who you're dealing with.



Fair, upfront pricing

The price you see is the price you pay. In FCFA, paid via MoMo.

No stress, no hidden arrangements, no surprises.

Five edges no incumbent has.

1

Trust as a product

We own "verified" — the one word no rival in Cameroon claims. In a scam-plagued market, that's the strongest possible wedge.

2

Two-sided liquidity

We convert fragmented agencies and idle private cars into supply, and become the demand layer above them.

3

Local-first rails

MoMo / FCFA pricing and full EN/FR parity — structural advantages global players won't prioritise.

4

First-mover on a proven model

The "Airbnb for cars" model works across Nigeria, Kenya and South Africa. We're first to bring it to Cameroon.

5

Asset-light

We monetise existing cars rather than buying a fleet — capital-efficient supply growth.

We monetise trust. Asset-light.

Marketplace commission

15–20% blended take-rate on every booking — the core engine.

Renter service fee

5–8% on the renter side, framed as verification & protection.

Verification & protection

Per-trip protection / deposit handling — also funds the moat.

Vendor subscriptions

Tiered plans for pro vendors & agencies: placement, analytics, faster payouts.

Illustrative unit economics

Per ~3-day domestic booking (to validate)

Avg booking value	35,000 FCFA
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Vendor commission (15%)	5,250 FCFA
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Renter fee (6%)	2,100 FCFA
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Gross take / booking	~7,350 FCFA
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≈ 21% of booking value, no fleet cost. Figures illustrative — the claim is the model shape and take-rate logic.

The real threat is distribution.

Top threats

Adjacent app adds rentals

OnGo already does event rentals; Gozem is expanding in Central Africa. Either could bolt a marketplace onto warm distribution.

Cold-start liquidity

Two sides needed at once; informal options are "good enough" for many today.

Trust must be real

One high-profile failure damages the core promise. Verification has to be substance.

Our defence

- Move first on vendor liquidity and lock supply before app-rich rivals turn rental on.
- Make verification & payments an operational moat — checks, deposits, insurance, recourse.
- Own the "verified rental" category in customers' minds, not just the feature.
- Depth of self-drive verification vs. ride-first DNA of mobility apps.

Proven model. Empty market. Right rails.

①

Proven elsewhere

P2P verified rental works across Nigeria, Kenya & South Africa — the model is de-risked.

②

Unclaimed in Cameroon

No verified two-sided rental marketplace exists here. First-mover on trust.

③

Rails are ready

MoMo adoption and in-app booking habits (via ride-hailing) have normalised cashless, verified transactions.

Where we are: live pre-launch waitlist in Douala & Yaoundé, building vendor supply ahead of monetised launch.

Car rental in Cameroon, done properly.

Verified. Local. Two-sided. First to market — monetising the scarcest commodity in the market: trust.

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